It was thus far from being an extreme body in any sense of the word, and certainly not so on the agrarian issue.

My own position in the province was that of a member of the Executive Council and its Agrarian Committee, and nothing more. I took a prominent part in our consultations and our other work, but in no sense did I take the leading part. Indeed no one can be said to have played the leading part in our province, as we had long accustomed ourselves to corporate and joint action, stress being always laid on the organisation and not on the individual. The president for the year was our temporary head, and represented us, but even he had no special authority.

I also functioned locally as a member of the Allahabad District Congress Committee. This Committee, under the leadership of its president, Purushottan Das Tandon, played an important part in the development of the agrarian situation. In 1930 it had given the lead in starting the no-tax campaign in the province. This was not because Allahabad district was the area affected most by the agricultural depression; the Taluqadari districts of Oudh were much worse off. But Allahabad district was better organised and more politically conscious, because Allahabad city was a centre of political activity and many prominent workers were frequently visiting the surrounding villages.

Immediately after the Delhi Pact of March 1931, we had hastened to send workers and notices to the rural areas, informing the peasantry that civil disobedience and the movement were off. On political grounds there was no bar to their payment of rent, and we advised them to pay. But we added that in view of the tremendous fall in prices we were of opinion that big remissions should be given to them, and we proposed that we should jointly try to obtain these. Even in normal times the rent was often an almost unbearable burden; with the slump in prices it was impossible to make full payment or even anything approaching it. We held conferences with representatives of the peasantry and, as a tentative proposal, suggested a general remission of fifty per cent., and in some cases more than that.

We tried to separate the agrarian issue entirely from the general question of civil disobedience. We wanted, at any rate in 1931, to consider it from the economic plane only, divorced from the political. This was difficult, as the two were anyhow intimately connected, and in the past had been closely associated. We, as a Congress organisation, were also definitely